

The number of big fishermen with no education is less than in the total sample, but the different levels of education show no relationship to the catch rate figures. There is, however, a connection between success as a fisherman and previous job history. More of these big fishermen have had other jobs previously than have the other fishermen, 55 per cent against 30 per cent. Further, a quarter of those earning more than £2 daily had been domestic servants in Rhodesia and South Africa, a much higher proportion than for other fishermen. Now, however, none of those earning more than £2 daily and only one of those earning between £1 and £2 daily want to leave fishing for another job. This would presumably

Virtually all big fishermen own their own boats, and they are the owners of the few plank boats in the sample. Similarly the expensive shore seines and the chirimira are owned by the richer fishermen: this is obviously circumscribed since these nets have high catch rates. A large proportion of the big fishermen also own gill nets.

The survey found that most of the big fishermen sampled are over 40 years old, and almost a third of those earning more than £2 daily are over 50. Adding this information to that on the initial money capital of fishermen, it would seem that one general pattern for these big fishermen is of a gradual build-up of capital and gear over the years. Only a small minority actually start with amounts of expensive equipment. Thus, one-half of those earning £2 or more started with less than £10 capital. However, as one would expect, there is a positive relationship between large money capital and catch rates in that the men who had capital of over £100 all earn between £1 and £5 daily. These large amounts of capital are used to buy shore seines which do achieve high catch rates. But scoop nets and gill nets, which cost far less, can also earn quite high incomes, and some fishermen are able to save steadily over the years to be able eventually to buy a shore seine. Thus, a large initial capital has not been a necessary precondition to high income.

among the small commercial fishermen none at present is using powered craft. Chilwa although this will be the next step for some. It is obvious that the backs of this classification, like any other, is that the clear distinction is spurious. Thus, for example, even the small-scale fishermen are commercial in sense that they sell part of their catch if they are able. And similarly a proportion of the catch of the large-scale fishermen is used for subsistence and their family and their work teams. Again the distinction into part-time and full-time is not clearcut. Some of the small-scale fishermen are also full-time but achieve lower earnings than the large-scale fishermen. Virtually all the large-scale fishermen have gardens (farms) although the "full-time" large-scale fishermen have no farms and employ labourers. Thus, rather than a clear classification there is a range of fishing activity from pure subsistence of a few, through large numbers of men earning a few shillings a day, to the successful commercial fishermen whom there is a core group and a penumbra with fluctuating fortunes. Even the "core" suffer fluctuations of income, particularly from the recent drying of Lake, but they also appear to be making a relatively quick recovery. Perhaps it is itself an indication of the more commercial, the larger-scale fishermen. These reasons any distinction is blurred. The present survey takes income from catch rates as the dividing line, with the more successful or "big" fishermen earning over £1 a day. This gives sixty-three fishermen, 15.3 per cent of the sample; of these, twenty, or 4.9 per cent, earn more than £2 daily, would be a "core."